

Bodhi McNally

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TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

My learning and teaching philosophy is grounded in the belief that students learn most effectively when they are active participants in the learning process rather than passive recipients of information.

When I first arrived at university, I quickly discovered that success in quantitative disciplines required more than simply attending lectures and tutorials. Data science, statistics and mathematics can be intimidating subjects, and many students approach them believing that they are “not mathematical people”. Early in my degree, I often found myself focusing on individual formulas, coding functions or assessment tasks without fully understanding how they connected to the broader discipline or to real-world problems.

I often think about learning as the difference between shopping at Aldi and shopping at an Apple Store. At Aldi, products are stacked on pallets, minimally presented, and customers are expected to work things out for themselves. The experience is efficient, but largely transactional. By contrast, Apple Stores are designed around engagement. Staff guide customers through products, explain how different components work together and help them understand the broader ecosystem. The experience is educational as much as it is transactional.

As an educator, I strive to create the “Apple Store” experience for my students. My goal is not simply to teach statistical methods, programming techniques or mathematical concepts. Rather, I aim to help students understand how these ideas connect to one another, how they can be applied to meaningful problems and why they matter beyond the classroom. Whether teaching hypothesis testing in an interdisciplinary science unit, data wrangling in an intensive course or introductory data science to large first-year cohorts, I seek to move beyond procedural knowledge and foster genuine understanding.

This philosophy has naturally led me towards Students-as-Partners initiatives and curriculum development work. I believe students are not merely consumers of education but valuable contributors to it. Through curriculum review, assessment redesign and educational scholarship, I have sought to create opportunities for students to influence and improve their own learning experiences. Feedback is therefore central to my practice, not only as a mechanism for supporting student learning, but also as a means of continuously improving my own teaching.

Ultimately, my goal as an educator is to help students develop confidence, curiosity and independence. By creating supportive learning environments, encouraging active participation and connecting concepts to authentic problems, I hope to equip students with the skills and mindset required for lifelong learning long after they leave the classroom.

EDUCATION

University of Sydney
Doctor of Medicine (MD)

Camperdown, NSW
2026 – Expected Dec 2029

University of Sydney
Bachelor of Science (Data Science and Genetics & Genomics)

Camperdown, NSW
2022 – 2024

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Tutor, MATH1062: Mathematics 1B 
School of Mathematics and Statistics

Feb 2026 – Present
University of Sydney

- Facilitate workshops covering calculus, differential equations and linear algebra for first-year undergraduate students.
- Provide academic support and formative feedback to develop mathematical reasoning and problem-solving skills.
- Support student learning through worked examples, collaborative activities and guided discussion.

Head Tutor, DATA1001: Introduction to Data Science 
School of Mathematics and Statistics

Jul 2024 – Present
University of Sydney

- Facilitate workshops of up to 60 students in one of the University’s largest undergraduate units, which enrolls more than 2,000 students annually.
- Coordinate assessment and marking processes across multiple teaching staff, ensuring consistency, fairness and adherence to unit marking standards.
- Provide guidance on complex marking decisions and adjudicate assessment edge cases, student queries and grading disputes.
- Observe tutors and demonstrators, providing structured feedback and mentorship to support teaching development and maintain educational quality across the unit.
- Develop teaching resources, assessment materials and best-practice marking guidelines to improve student learning outcomes and assessment consistency.
- Collaborate closely with the unit coordinator and teaching team on curriculum delivery, assessment design and continuous improvement initiatives.

Workshop Facilitator, SCIE1001: Sydney Science 2050: Towards the Future 
Faculty of Science

Apr 2024 – Sep 2025
University of Sydney

- Delivered intensive statistics and hypothesis testing workshops for interdisciplinary cohorts of first-year science students.
- Taught foundational concepts in statistical inference, experimental design, hypothesis testing and interpretation of scientific evidence.
- Facilitated small-group learning activities and applied examples to support students from diverse scientific disciplines in developing quantitative reasoning skills.

- Reappointed across four teaching periods (Apr 2024, Sep 2024, Apr 2025 and Sep 2025) in recognition of teaching effectiveness and subject matter expertise.
- Junior Lecturer, Data Wrangling OLE (Winter Intensive)**  Jul 2024
School of Mathematics and Statistics *University of Sydney*
- Appointed as a Junior Lecturer to independently deliver teaching within the University’s intensive Data Wrangling Open Learning Environment (OLE).
 - Delivered instruction in data wrangling, data visualisation and reproducible analytical workflows using R to students from a broad range of academic disciplines.
 - Supported students in developing practical skills in data cleaning, transformation, visualisation and communication through hands-on computational activities.
- Demonstrator, DATA1001: Introduction to Data Science**  Feb 2024 – Jun 2024
School of Mathematics and Statistics *University of Sydney*
- Provided in-class support for practical workshops and assisted students with statistical programming, data analysis and problem-solving activities.
 - Contributed to student learning through formative feedback and small-group teaching within a large-enrolment introductory data science unit.

EDUCATIONAL LEADERSHIP AND SCHOLARSHIP

- Curriculum Review and Development Team Member, DATA1x Program** Jul 2024 – Present
School of Mathematics and Statistics *University of Sydney*
- Collaborate within a Students-as-Partners framework to review, innovate and redevelop curriculum across large-enrolment data science units serving more than 2,000 students annually.
 - Contribute to assessment redesign, curriculum innovation and learning resource development to improve student engagement and learning outcomes.
 - Develop best-practice marking guidelines to improve consistency, fairness and quality of assessment feedback across large teaching teams.
- Co-author, Global Students as Partners Roundtable 2026** May 2026 – Present
University of Sydney *Sydney, NSW*
- Co-author of an educational scholarship submission entitled *The Dream Teams – Student-Led Curriculum Review, Innovation & Development in Massive Data Science Cohorts*.
 - Examining how Students-as-Partners models can support scalable curriculum innovation, assessment improvement and continuous quality enhancement within large undergraduate programs.
 - Contributing to the scholarship of teaching and learning through dissemination of innovative approaches to curriculum review and educational partnership.

STUDENT FEEDBACK AND EVIDENCE OF TEACHING EFFECTIVENESS

The following aggregated results are drawn from the University of Sydney’s *Feedback for Teachers – Teaching in Tutorials* survey and provide evidence of sustained teaching effectiveness across first-year undergraduate teaching. Results are aggregated across 486 student responses collected between 2024 and 2025. Mean scores were calculated by assigning numerical values to the ordinal response categories: Strongly Disagree (1), Disagree (2), Neutral (3), Agree (4) and Strongly Agree (5).

Survey Item	Agree (%)	Mean
My tutor came to class well-prepared to help me learn.	98	4.50
I normally received helpful feedback on my learning from my tutor.	82	4.09
My tutor explained things clearly.	96	4.48
I felt comfortable asking questions in tutorials.	84	4.13
My tutor respected each student and responded to individual needs.	93	4.39
My tutor maintained a classroom atmosphere conducive to learning.	94	4.34
Overall my tutor effectively supported my learning.	96	4.45

These results demonstrate consistently strong student perceptions across preparation, clarity of explanation, learning support and classroom environment. Particularly encouraging are the high levels of agreement regarding preparedness (98%), clarity of explanation (96%) and overall support for learning (96%), which align closely with my teaching philosophy of creating engaging, supportive and student-centred learning environments.

Student comments further illustrate the impact of my teaching approach. Recurring themes include clarity of explanation, approachability, enthusiasm and the creation of a supportive learning environment that encourages participation.

“Bodhi explained difficult statistical concepts in a way that was easy to understand and apply.”

“One of the most engaging and approachable tutors I have had. I always felt comfortable asking questions.”

“The feedback on assessments was detailed, constructive and genuinely helped me improve.”

“The tutorials were well organised and connected the theory to practical examples, making the content much easier to understand.”

“Bodhi clearly cared about student learning and always took the time to answer questions thoroughly.”